

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K 5
♥ J 9 5 2
♦ A 8 6
♣ 9 7 6 3

♠ Q J 9 8 7 3
♥ K Q 6
♦ 7 2
♣ J 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 10 2
♥ 10 8 4
♦ J 10 9 3
♣ Q 10 5

♠ 6 4
♥ A 7 3
♦ K Q 5 4
♣ A K 8 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT

Pass 4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North

Lead: ♦ J

West plays the other high honor you play low. If West plays low you guess whether to play the ♠ K, or ♠ 10. Your best play is to assume the two honors were split and play the ♠ Q.

Leading twice toward the ♠ Q J gives you a guarantee on this layout because West held a doubleton high honor.

Now

Here East has taken your ♠ J with the ♠ A. When you again lead a small ♠ from dummy say that West plays the ♠ 5.

You might think that East is just as likely to have held an original doubleton ♠ A K as doubleton ♠ A 10, and that playing the ♠ 9 would be as good a play as ♠ Q.

This is untrue for a very classy-named reason - **The Principle of Restricted Choice**. You may not even believe it when you read it, but it's mathematically sound. If East were dealt an original ♠ A K, he would have been just as likely to win with the ♠ K as with the ♠ A. The fact that he actually won the ♠ A makes it less likely that he also holds the ♠ K.

HE WHO KNOWS, GOES You **KNOW** your side has 26-28 points. You **KNOW** your side has 8 or more ♠ s. You **GO** to 4♠.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♦ J.

North plays 4♠. East leads the ♦ J.

Losers: ♠ 2/3 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 0 : Total = 3/4

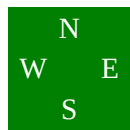
You are definitely going to lose the ♦ A and the ♠ A K. Therefore you must plan to avoid losing a third ♠.

You should lead **UP TO** your honor cards. Cover the ♦ J and lose to West's ♦ A. Win his return (probably another ♦) in dummy. Lead a small ♠ to your ♠ J. East wins with an honor and probably plays the ♦ 10. Ruff it, lead a ♣ to dummy and lead the last ♠. If

Board 2
West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A J 5 2
♥ 8 5 4
♦ A K J 3
♣ 8 4

♠ 10 7 4
♥ A J 3
♦ 10 8 5 2
♣ J 9 3



♠ Q 8 6 3
♥ 9 7 2
♦ Q 7
♣ A K Q 6

♠ K 9
♥ K Q 10 6
♦ 9 6 4
♣ 10 7 5 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	1 ♠	Pass
2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠	

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♥K

It kinda makes you wish you'd bid 2NT after all doesn't it?

At least the picture is clear. Very clear. You have no wiggle room left so you must bring in the ♠s without losing a trick. So South **MUST** have the ♠K. Therefore you assume South does hold the ♠K.

Suppose you lead the ♠Q. South will play his ♠K and force you to play dummy's ♠A. Then one of the defenders will win the third ♠ with the ♠10 or ♠9.

No, you only have one chance to make this contract - South must hold a doubleton ♠ K x. So you lead a **SMALL** ♠ from your hand and finesse dummy's ♠J. Then play the ♠A, dropping South's ♠K, then pull the last trump with the ♠Q.

The reason you must not lead the ♠Q is that South will always cover and that will force you to use two of your honors on one trick.

Since you would only have one more honor you'd be bound to lose a trick.

A jump to 2NT would not be a terrible bid. But it is more important to show your 4-card Major.

So you bid 1 ♠ instead. Partner raises to 2 ♠.

It's another case of **HE WHO KNOWS, GOES**. You know you have at least 26 points and 8 ♠s. Of course you trust that partner would not raise a suit you bid as responder with only 3 trumps. So you bid 4 ♠.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads the ♥K. The defense takes the first three ♥ tricks, then switch to a ♣.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads the ♥K. The defense takes the first three ♥ tricks, then switch to a ♣.

Losers: ♠ ? : ♥ 3 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 0 : Total = 3?

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 9 8 4

♥ A 5

♦ 9 3

♣ Q J 10

♠ A 7 2

♥ Q J 3

♦ Q 8 6 2

♣ 9 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 5 3

♥ 10 7 6 4 2

♦ A 7 5

♣ 7 5 3

♠ K 6

♥ K 9 8

♦ K J 10 4

♣ A K 8 2

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ Q

you can just figure out which Ace West has you can establish that suit first.

But you don't have to guess, there is a better way. West overcalled at the 2-level with a Queen-high suit and one outside Ace. THAT is bold. Surely he has at least a 6-card suit to justify that overcall. If so, then a simple hold-up will be worthwhile. So you let West hold the first trick, and when he leads another ♠ you win the ♠K in your hand. If West has a 6-card suit East is now void of ♠s.

Play ♦s to drive out the ♦A. If East has it he will not have another ♠ to force you with. If West has it he can force out your last ♠, but then won't have the ♥A for an entry. However the Aces are split - as long as West doesn't have both - you will establish 9 tricks.

Without the holdup you could still have made the contract, but only if you had established the ♥ winners first. That would have been a total guess.

With the holdup it didn't matter which red suit you established first.

With 17 points and a balanced hand you naturally open 1NT. West overcalls 2 ♠. Your partner then bids 2NT.

Your partner invited you to bid 3NT if you had 17 points, and you have 17 points. You trust your partner so you bid 3NT.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠Q.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠Q.

Winner count: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 2 : Total = 4

This looks scary. Needing 5 more tricks means you are going to have to establish **BOTH** red suits. And with only two ♠ stoppers you have to hope West doesn't have both red Aces. If he does, you're down, so just assume that he only has one of them. Now if

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q J 8 6 2

♥ 5

♦ Q 6 4

♣ 9 7 2

♠ 10 9 7 3

♥ A K 8 4

♦ 10 8

♣ A 10 3



♠ 5 4

♥ 10 9 6 3

♦ A K 9 2

♣ Q 8 5

♠ A

♥ Q J 7 2

♦ J 7 5 3

♣ K J 6 4

Don't even think twice. Just pass and wonder why the opponents aren't bidding.

East would play 2♠.

Click

West plays 2♠. North leads ♥A, then ♥K.

East plays 2♠. South leads ♥A, then ♥K.

Losers: ♠ 1/2 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 3 : Total = 5/6

West

North

East

South

2♠

All Pass

2♠ by West

Lead: ♥A

you might as well take extra pains if you can do so without risk.

If North has both ♣A and ♣K you could save yourself 1 ♣ loser, but the odds are about 3 to 1 against that. Your best chance of making this contract is just to hold your ♠ losers to 1. With an expected 3-2 split there will not be a problem, but

So after you ruff the ♥K you do **NOT** play the ♠K. Instead you play a ♦ to dummy and lead a ♠ toward your honors. Your extra pains pay off when South plays the ♠A, which was a singleton.

If you had led your ♠K South would have won the ♠A and you would later have to give up a ♠ trick to North's ♠10.

It costs nothing to make a careful play. Most of the time it doesn't matter, but every now and again it pays off in a contract that couldn't be made without the careful play.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 4 2
 ♥ K Q 10
 ♦ A J 7 5 3
 ♣ Q 8 7

♠ 7
 ♥ A J 9 8 7 5 4
 ♦ 8
 ♣ K 10 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 10
 ♥ 3
 ♦ K 10 9 6 2
 ♣ A J 9 4

♠ A K 9 8 6 5 3
 ♥ 6 2
 ♦ Q 4
 ♣ 5 2

West	North	East	South
	3♥		

All Pass

3♥ by North

Lead: ♠Q

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1/2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 4 : Total = 6/7

You really really want to say 3♠. Here are three good reasons you shouldn't.

You have 9 ♥s between you. You may have only 7 ♠s. If you bid 3♠ partner may bid again. You haven't been doubled.

South would play 3♥.

Click

North plays 3♥. East leads the ♠Q.

North plays 3♥. East leads the ♠Q.

It turns out there was a fourth reason not to bid 3♠ - the opponents might lead the suit.

The ♠ lead is about the best thing that could have happened to you. You win with dummy's ♠A and play ♠K, discarding your ♦. You then lead a small ♣, covering anything West plays. You'd like to ruff a ♣ if you can, but if they play trumps to stop you then you'd like the trump play to come from East. East leads the ♥3, West plays the ♥K, and you win with the ♥A. You play a small ♣. If the defender who wins the ♣ doesn't play another trump then you can ruff your third ♣ in dummy. If the defender **DOES** play a trump, then you lose only one trump trick. You end up going down 1, which is pretty good.

Some contracts are impossible. So you just play to keep the damage as low as possible.